

Client Onboarding SOP

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Owner: Account Manager | **Updated:** July 2026

The step-by-step process for onboarding every new client from Closed Won to first deliverable delivered.

Key tools used in this SOP:

- ClickUp — CRM, delivery folders, client portal, access trackers,  Master Shared Links Tracker,  Onboarding Handoff
- Google Forms — Client Onboarding Form: Marketing Services
- Revital Hub (hub.revitalproductions.com) — Onboarding Checklist, Content Strategy Builder, Audits, Competitor Analysis
-  Client Communication Policy — Part A shared with client, Part B for internal team

 Email Templates doc — Welcome Email (#8), Intake Form Follow-Up (#9), Kick-Off Confirmation (#10)

About the Client Intake Form

The **Client Onboarding Form: Marketing Services** is sent to every new client immediately after the contract is signed. It must be completed before the kick-off call is scheduled.

- When to Send:** Same day the contract is signed — included in the Welcome Email (Template #8)
- Deadline:** Client must complete before kick-off call is scheduled
- Follow-Up:** If not submitted within 48 hours, send Intake Form Follow-Up (Template #9)

Responses: Google Forms → Responses tab — pull individual client response before red flag review

Form Section Reference

Section	What It Covers	Key Fields to Review
Section 1 — Contact Info	Who the client is and how to work with them	Approval timeline, decision makers, preferred communication
Section 2 — Business Info	Company overview	Social handles, industry, location

Section 3 — Brand Identity	Brand foundation	Brand guide status, dos/don'ts, target audience, competitors
Section 4 — Content Preferences	Creative direction	Tone of voice, visual style, brands they admire, creative freedom
Section 5 — Services	What they contracted	Confirm against signed SOW — flag any mismatch
Section 6 — Goals & Strategy	What they want to achieve	Goals, KPIs, current marketing, innovation comfort score
Section 7 — Previous Agency Experience	Agency history	Why they left, frustrations, biggest concerns
Section 8 — Platform Access	What platforms exist and who controls them	Admin access status, platform list per category
Section 8B — Access Recovery	Previous agency/developer holds access	Which platforms, who controls them
Section 8C — Credentials Handoff	How access will be shared	Preferred credential sharing method
Section 9 — Budget & Channels	Investment and priorities	Budget range, ad spend, channel importance
Section 10 — Final Details	Start date	Confirm against contract

Step 1 — Deal Closed Won (Day 0)

- Update Status to **Closed Won** and Onboarding Status to **Onboarding** in CRM → Deals
- Set Start Date, End Date, Revenue, and Objective on the Deal record
- Set Lead Source on the Deal record if not already set
- Tag the Delivery Lead on the Deal
- Send the **Welcome Email (Template #8)** within **24 hours** of signing — include the intake form link
- Set a 48-hour follow-up reminder — if form not submitted, send **Intake Form Follow-Up (Template #9)**

Step 2 — Intake Form Red Flag Review (Day 1-2)

Do not schedule the kick-off call until the form is submitted and reviewed.

- Pull the client's completed form responses from Google Forms → Responses tab
- Review all sections against the Red Flag Checklist below
- Cross-reference **Section 5 (Services)** against the signed SOW — flag any mismatch
- Cross-reference **Section 10 (Start Date)** against the contract start date
- Log all findings in the Comments field of the client's Deal record in ClickUp — include section and question references

Red Flag Checklist

From Section 1 — Contact Information

- ☐ Client selected 72 hours or "Other" for approval timeline (S1, Q8) — discuss delivery schedule impact at kick-off
- ☐ Multiple decision makers or approvers listed (S1, Q9) — identify the final approver and add to portal

From Section 3 — Brand Identity

- ☐ Client selected "No, we need help developing our brand identity" (S3, Q4) — flag if brand development is not in the SOW

From Section 4 — Content Preferences

- ☐ Client selected "Strict direction" for creative freedom (S4, Q14) — brief creative team; expect more revision rounds
- ☐ Client scored 1-3 on innovation scale (S6, Q7) but services include Reels or experimental formats — align on creative direction first

From Section 5 — Services

- ☐ Services selected that are not in the signed SOW (S5, Q1) — clarify scope before kick-off

From Section 6 — Goals & Strategy

- ☐ Budget "Under \$1,000" (S9, Q2) but goals include leads, traffic, or product launch (S6, Q1) — expectation mismatch; have pricing conversation first
- ☐ Multiple high-cost services selected but budget is "\$1,000–\$3,000" — discuss priorities
- ☐ Short-term goals are unrealistic for the timeline or budget (S6, Q3) — address in kick-off

From Section 7 — Previous Agency Experience

- ☐ Worked with 3+ agencies recently (S7, Q1) — may indicate difficult relationship or unrealistic expectations
- ☐ Multiple exits citing "Poor communication" (S7, Q3) — may indicate client was unresponsive; set clear expectations upfront

- Exited for "Results didn't meet expectations" (S7, Q3) — align on realistic timelines before starting
- "Losing creative control" is a top concern (S7, Q8) — extra reassurance needed; brief delivery team
- Strong negative language in frustrations (S7, Q5) — assign most experienced account manager

From Section 8 — Platform Access

- "No" or "Not sure" for admin access (S8, Q13) — flag to Delivery Lead; delays production start
- Previous agency or developer holds access (S8, Q14) — review Section 8B; recovery must happen before work begins
- Meta BM, Google Ads, or GA4 not set up (S8, Q2-4) — additional setup time needed; adjust timeline
- "Need help setting it up" for credential sharing (S8C, Q1) — assign technical team member to guide them

From Section 9 — Budget

- Budget question blank or "We'll discuss" (S9, Q2) — do not proceed; confirm before kick-off
- Current ad spend (S9, Q1) significantly higher than Revital services budget — clarify handoff process

No Flags Found

Log: *"Intake form reviewed — no red flags — [date]"* in Deal record Comments and proceed to Step 3.

Flags Found

- Log each flag with section and question number in Deal record Comments
 - Notify leadership within 24 hours
 - Do not schedule kick-off until leadership approves a plan for each flag
 - Address flags directly and professionally during the kick-off call
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Step 3 — Hub Client Profile Setup (Day 1)

- Log in to the Hub at hub.revitalproductions.com using your @revitalproductions.com email
- Click **Add New Client** and create a new client profile
- Populate the Hub profile using intake form responses:
 - Company name and industry (Section 2)
 - Brand story and core values (Section 3)
 - Target audience (Section 3, Q7)
 - Competitors (Section 3, Q8)

- Tone of voice and visual style (*Section 4*)
 - Goals and KPIs (*Section 6*)
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Step 4 — Hub Onboarding Checklist & Content Strategy Builder (Day 1-2)

- Navigate to the **Client Onboarding** tab in the Hub under the client's profile
- Use intake form responses to pre-fill as much as possible before the kick-off call
- Work through all three phases:
 - **Phase 1 — Pre-Onboarding:** Review SOW, assign team, set up ClickUp board — cross-reference Section 5
 - **Phase 2 — Admin & Technical Setup:** Send welcome package, gather access — reference Sections 8, 8B, 8C
 - **Phase 3 — Discovery & Kickoff:** Use Sections 3, 4, and 6 to prepare the kick-off agenda
- Target: 100% checklist completion before updating to Active in CRM

Run the Content Strategy Builder before the kick-off call:

- Open the **Content Strategy Builder** in the Hub under the client's profile
- Map intake form responses to the 12 Builder sections:
 - Company Overview → Section 2
 - Business Goals → Section 6
 - Target Audience → Section 3, Q7
 - Brand Identity → Sections 3 and 4
 - Competitor Analysis → Section 3, Q8
 - Content Strategy → Section 4
 - Platform Strategy → Section 4, Q8 and Section 8, Q2
 - KPIs → Section 6, Q2
- Copy the Content Strategy Builder URL from your browser
- Share the completed strategy summary with the full delivery team before the kick-off call

 The Content Strategy Builder must be completed **before** the Sales → Delivery Handoff form is submitted so the delivery team has the full strategy available from day one.

Step 4B — Sales → Delivery Handoff Form (Day 2)

 **Why this step exists:** With a team, the Account Manager and Delivery team need a structured handoff so nothing falls through the cracks. This form creates a task in the Onboarding Handoff list that the delivery team can reference throughout the engagement — it's their single source of truth for who the client is, what's been contracted, and what's needed first.

Open the Sales → Delivery Handoff form:

- Go to **Growth → Closing & Onboarding Handoff →  Onboarding Handoff**
- Click the  **Sales → Delivery Handoff** form tab
- Or use the quick link from  **Team Quick Links** doc

Fill out all 6 sections:

Section	What to Fill In	Where to Get the Info
 Client Overview	Company name, dates, contract value, billing type, sensitivity level	CRM Deal record + intake form
 Services & Deliverables	Services, first deliverable, first deadline	SOW + intake Section 5
 Team Assignment	Delivery Lead, Content Creator(s)	Leadership decision
 Platform Access Status	Current status of all platforms	 Access & Logins Tracker
 Links	CRM Deal link, Portal link	ClickUp
 Notes	Any context the delivery team needs	Red flag log + personal notes

After submitting:

- A new task is created in the Onboarding Handoff list with status **Not Started**
- Open the task and fill in the description template (*Platform Access, Red Flags, Links sections*)
- Assign the task to the Delivery Lead
- Progress the status as each onboarding step is completed:

Not Started → Welcome Email Sent → Intake Form Received → ClickUp Setup Done → Kick-Off Scheduled → Handed Off to Delivery → Complete

Step 5 — ClickUp Workspace Setup (Day 1-2)

 **Note on Demo Portal:** A demo client folder named " **Demo Client — Revital Productions**" exists in Delivery → Clients. This is NOT a real client — it was created specifically to record the Loom onboarding video shown in the Client Welcome Template portal. It contains realistic dummy data across all 8 lists. Do not modify, delete, or use this folder for any real client work. If the Loom video needs to be re-recorded, this folder can be used as the demo environment again.

Create the client's delivery folder from the ClickUp Template:

1. Go to **Delivery Space → Clients folder**
2. Click **+ New Folder** → select **From Template**
3. Select the **Client Portal** ClickUp Template
4. Name the new folder with the client's company name (*e.g. "Acme Wellness"*)
5. Confirm all 8 lists were created correctly inside the new folder:
 -  Campaign Briefs
 -  Content Calendar
 -  Recurring Deliverables
 -  Client Feedback & Revisions
 -  Assets & Brand Files
 -  Reports & Analytics
 -  Active Projects & Tasks
 -  Completed Work

 **Reference master:** The original copy in **Guides & Templates → Client Portal Template** is the permanent backup/reference master and is never duplicated from directly or edited for a specific client. All new client folders are created from the saved ClickUp Template, which is built from this reference copy. If the ClickUp Template ever needs updating, update the Guides & Templates master first, then re-save the ClickUp Template from it.

Create a ClickUp Tag for this client:

 **Why tags matter:** Every client gets their own tag in ClickUp. This tag is applied to all 7 of their tracker tasks in the Master Shared Links Tracker — making it easy to filter and find all links for a specific client at any time.

1. In ClickUp click your **workspace name** at the top left → **Settings** → **Tags**
2. Click **+ Add Tag**
3. Name it exactly as the client's folder name (*e.g. "Acme Wellness"*)

4. Choose a color (*use a different color per client for easy visual identification*)
 5. Save the tag
 6. Once the 7 tracker tasks are created by Zapier (*within 15 minutes of folder creation*) — open each tracker task and apply this tag
 7. All 7 tasks are now tagged and filterable by client name
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Generate and verify shared view links — do not skip this:

 **Why this matters:** Templates do NOT carry over shared links — every list gets a brand new, unique list ID when created from a template. Renaming the folder does not connect an old link to the new folder. Reusing a link from another client's portal risks exposing one client's confidential data to another. This is the single highest-risk manual step in onboarding — treat it with care every time.

1. Open the **new** client's list — confirm in the ClickUp interface that you are looking at the correct client's folder before doing anything else
 2. Click **Share** → toggle on public sharing → copy the link
 3. Repeat for every list that needs a shared view:
 -  Campaign Briefs
 -  Content Calendar
 -  Active Projects & Tasks
 -  Completed Work
 -  Assets & Brand Files
 -  Reports & Analytics
 4. **Log every shared view link** in the  **Master Shared Links Tracker** (*Operations → Tools & Tech Stack*) — one entry per list, per client
 5. **Verify before sending to the client:** open each link in an incognito window and confirm it shows only this client's data
 6. Mark each entry in the tracker as  Verified once confirmed
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Generate and verify form links — do not skip this:

 **Why this matters:** The forms built on the template lists (*Guides & Templates → Client Portal Template*) are NOT the forms clients use. Each client's folder gets its own Campaign Briefs and Client Feedback & Revisions lists with their own unique list IDs. Forms must be built on — or confirmed to exist on — the client's own lists, and the form links must be client-specific. Using the template form links means client submissions land in the template list, not the client's own folder.

1. Open the **new** client's  **Campaign Briefs** list
 2. Click + **View** → confirm a  **Submit a Content Request** form view exists (*should carry over from template*)
 3. If it exists — click the form → click **Share** → copy the `forms.clickup.com` link
 4. If it does NOT exist — build it from scratch using the spec in the Revision & Feedback Process SOP
 5. Repeat for the  **Client Feedback & Revisions** list →  **Submit a Revision Request** form
 6. **Log both form links** in the  **Master Shared Links Tracker** — one entry per form, per client
 7. **Verify both forms in incognito** — open each link, confirm the form loads and submits correctly, confirm a test task appears in the correct client list (*not the template list*)
 8. **Update the client's portal doc** with both form links — replace the template placeholder links with the client-specific form links
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Build the portal and finish setup:

- Build the client's portal doc by copying the Client Welcome Template and pasting in this client's new, verified shared view links, form links, and Quick Link buttons
 - Confirm Status options on the new folder's lists match exactly what's documented in the Custom Field Options Reference doc, Section 0
 - Log all platform access in  **Access & Logins Tracker** — reference Sections 8 and 8C
 - Set up ad accounts in  **Client Ad Account Tracker** — reference Section 8, Q2-3
 - If Section 8B was completed — flag access recovery platforms in the tracker with "Recovery Needed"
 - Create the client's Contact and Company records in CRM if not already done — set the `Role` field on each contact (*Primary Decision Maker / Approver / Day-to-Day Contact*)
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Step 6 — Kick-Off Call (Day 3-5)

- Send **Kick-Off Call Confirmation (Template #10)** when scheduling — only after intake form is submitted
- Before the call: review the full intake form, the client's Hub profile, the Content Strategy Builder output, and the red flag log
- Share the Onboarding Handoff task with the delivery team before the call so they're prepared
- During the call:
 - Share and explain the **Client Communication Policy (Part A)**
 - Walk the client through their portal — show them how to use the Content Request and Revision Request forms
 - Use Section 4 (Content Preferences) to guide the creative direction conversation
 - Use Section 6 (Goals & Strategy) to anchor the strategy conversation

- Confirm approval process — cross-reference Section 1, Q8 and Q9
 - Address any red flag items directly
 - Collect any brand assets not uploaded in Section 3 — upload to 📁 Assets & Brand Files in ClickUp
 - Log call summary in 📞 **Client Strategy Meeting Notes** in ClickUp within 2 hours
 - Send written follow-up email within 24 hours with action items
 - Update Onboarding Handoff task status to **Kick-Off Scheduled** (or *Handed Off to Delivery if call is complete*)
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Step 7 — Initial Hub Audits (Week 1)

- **SEO clients** → Run the **SEO Audit Checklist** — confirm GA4 and Search Console access (Section 8, Q4) first
- **Social media clients** → Run the **Social Media Audit** — reference Section 8, Q2 for platform list
- **Website clients** → Run the **UX/UI Audit Checklist** — confirm website platform (Section 8, Q5) first

Save all audit results to the client's Hub profile. Share findings with the client at the first strategy call.

Step 8 — Competitor Analysis (Week 1-2)

- Open the **Competitor Analysis** tool in the Hub under the client's profile
 - Use Section 3, Q8 of the intake form (competitors) as the starting list
 - Cross-reference with Section 4, Q5 (brands they admire)
 - Complete the full SWOT analysis for up to 3 competitors
 - Use findings to inform the content strategy and positioning
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Step 9 — Onboarding Complete

- Confirm all Hub checklist items are 100% complete
 - Confirm all platform access from Section 8 is received and logged in ClickUp
 - Update Onboarding Status to **Active** in CRM
 - Set up 🔄 **Recurring Deliverables** in ClickUp for monthly reports and check-ins
 - Schedule the first monthly strategy or performance review
 - Update Client Health to 🟢 Green in CRM if onboarding went smoothly
 - Update Onboarding Handoff task status to **Complete**
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Onboarding Checklist

CRM & Communication

- ☐ Deal marked Closed Won in CRM
- ☐ Welcome email sent with intake form link within 24 hours (*Template #8*)
- ☐ Intake form completed by client — confirmed in Google Forms Responses tab
- ☐ Intake form follow-up sent if not submitted within 48 hours (*Template #9*)

Red Flag Review

- ☐ Section 1 reviewed — approval timeline and decision makers checked
- ☐ Section 3 reviewed — brand guide status checked
- ☐ Section 4 reviewed — creative freedom level checked
- ☐ Section 5 reviewed — services cross-referenced against signed SOW
- ☐ Section 6 reviewed — goals and budget cross-referenced for expectation mismatch
- ☐ Section 7 reviewed — agency history checked for red flags
- ☐ Section 8 reviewed — platform access and admin status checked
- ☐ Section 8B reviewed — access recovery noted if applicable
- ☐ Section 9 reviewed — budget confirmed and cross-referenced with goals
- ☐ Section 10 reviewed — start date cross-referenced with contract
- ☐ All red flags logged in Deal record with section and question references
- ☐ Red flags escalated to leadership and resolved before kick-off (*if applicable*)

Hub & Content Strategy

- ☐ Logged into Hub with @revitalproductions.com email
- ☐ Hub client profile created and populated with intake form data
- ☐ Hub onboarding checklist started — all 3 phases
- ☐ Content Strategy Builder completed using intake form data
- ☐ Content Strategy Builder URL saved for reference
- ☐ Strategy summary shared with delivery team

Sales → Delivery Handoff

- ☐ Sales → Delivery Handoff form submitted (*Growth → Onboarding Handoff → Sales → Delivery Handoff form*)
- ☐ Onboarding Handoff task description filled in (*Platform Access, Red Flags, Links*)

- ☐ Onboarding Handoff task assigned to Delivery Lead
- ☐ Delivery team notified and has reviewed the handoff task

ClickUp Workspace Setup

- ☐ New client folder created from the ClickUp Template inside Delivery → Clients
- ☐ Folder renamed with client company name
- ☐ All 8 lists confirmed present inside the new folder
- ☐ Status and custom fields confirmed to match Custom Field Options Reference doc
- ☐ ClickUp tag created for this client (*Settings → Tags → + Add Tag → client name*)
- ☐ Tag applied to all 7 tracker tasks in Master Shared Links Tracker once Zapier creates them

Shared View Links (6 total)

- ☐ Campaign Briefs — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ Content Calendar — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ Active Projects & Tasks — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ Completed Work — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ Assets & Brand Files — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ Reports & Analytics — shared view link generated, logged, verified in incognito
- ☐ All 6 shared view links logged in  Master Shared Links Tracker

Form Links (2 total)

- ☐ Campaign Briefs — Submit a Content Request form link generated and logged
- ☐ Client Feedback & Revisions — Submit a Revision Request form link generated and logged
- ☐ Both form links verified in incognito — test submission confirmed landing in correct client list
- ☐ Both form links updated in client's portal doc buttons
- ☐ Both form links logged in  Master Shared Links Tracker

Portal Setup

- ☐ Client portal doc built from Client Welcome Template
- ☐ All shared view links and form links pasted into portal doc
- ☐ Platform access logged in  Access & Logins Tracker
- ☐ Ad accounts logged in  Client Ad Account Tracker
- ☐ Access recovery platforms flagged if Section 8B was completed
- ☐ Contact and Company records created in CRM with Role field set

Kick-Off Call

- ☐ Kick-off call scheduled and confirmed (*Template #10 sent*)
- ☐ Onboarding Handoff task shared with delivery team before call
- ☐ Client Communication Policy (Part A) shared and explained during call
- ☐ Portal walkthrough completed — client shown how to use Content Request and Revision Request forms
- ☐ Red flag items addressed during kick-off call
- ☐ Brand assets collected and uploaded
- ☐ Call summary logged in 📞 Client Strategy Meeting Notes within 2 hours
- ☐ Written follow-up email sent within 24 hours
- ☐ Onboarding Handoff task status updated

Strategy & Production Setup

- ☐ Initial audits run in Hub
- ☐ Competitor analysis completed
- ☐ First campaign brief submitted and approved
- ☐ Content Calendar built based on Content Strategy Builder output
- ☐ Client portal shared with client

Onboarding Complete

- ☐ All Hub checklist items 100% complete
- ☐ All platform access confirmed and logged
- ☐ Onboarding Status updated to Active in CRM
- ☐ Client Health set to ● Green in CRM
- ☐ Recurring deliverables and monthly check-ins set up in ClickUp
- ☐ First monthly report or strategy review scheduled
- ☐ Onboarding Handoff task status set to Complete

Last updated: July 2026 | Owner: Revital Productions Account Manager